

M1 I Reflective Essay

A defining moment in my life that shaped how I see myself was when I joined a volunteer program in my community. I worked with children who didn't have many opportunities, helping them with schoolwork and life skills. At first, it was challenging and sometimes discouraging, but I realized that patience, consistency, and genuine effort made a big difference in their lives. From this, I learned the meaning of "*Pag nag-tanim ng maayos, may bútid*"—if you put in care and effort, growth will follow. This philosophy now guides me: small, steady actions lead to meaningful results over time.

Right now, I see myself as hardworking, curious, and determined, but I know I still struggle with procrastination and self-doubt. My dreams are to grow in my chosen field, develop my skills, and help others along the way. Ten years from now, I hope my future self remembers that growth is a process and that rewards come from consistent effort, not instant results. I want to stay patient, kind, and focused on the small steps that build long-term success. By embracing challenges and learning from mistakes, I can become the confident and capable person I hope to be.

When I think about my real self and ideal self, I notice that they are not fully aligned yet. I am trying to balance ambition with patience, learning to trust that steady effort produces real results. A moment that showed me this was leading a group project in school, where I had to guide my team despite doubts and challenges. By focusing on planning, communication, and effort, I was able to help the team succeed and grow alongside them. Experiences like this remind me that if I nurture my actions carefully, just like planting seeds, I will eventually see the fruits of my work.